

**Regular Meeting
Monday, June 24, 2019
Medford School Committee
Medford High School**

Present: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruggiero, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke (Arrived at 7:35PM), Superintendent Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell, Assistant Superintendent Kirsteen Patterson.

Roll Call and Salute the Flag - Meeting called to order at 7:15PM.

Approval of Minutes of June 3, 2019 - Motion to approve offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds and Approval of Payrolls - Ms. DiBenedetto asked about a line item about Eric Esner's reimbursement for the Ethics Bowl. Legal services for \$3,000. Ms. Patterson clarified that was under the IDEA grant. Motion to approve offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto. Roll call vote.

6 affirmative

1 absent - Mayor Burke

Motion passes.

Report of Committees: Special Education Subcommittee - Ms. DiBenedetto - The Special Education Subcommittee met on May 28th. We discussed disability awareness professional development for all teachers, which went extremely well. We also discussed out of school time: camps, before/after school programs. Inclusive training will be given to all personnel in before/after school programs. We are very thankful for Kathy Medaglio's service. Motion to accept the report and place on file offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Report of Committees: Rules Subcommittee - Ms. Kreatz - We had two meetings to discuss the school committee policies document. We updated gendered language and included policy information standards. Ms. DiBenedetto - The language that says you can only speak for three minutes looks like a resident can only speak once. Mr. Ruseau - This is not the regular community participation section, this is about speaking on an item on the agenda. Ms. DiBenedetto - Okay. Section 8: Does that mean the Chairperson can decline any item brought forward by a member? That happened to me last year and I would like it to be addressed. Mr. Ruseau - This is current policy and we are following Robert's Rules. If this does happen, it can be put on the agenda at the next regularly scheduled meeting. As long as four members say yes,

the Chair loses the right to refuse. Ms. DiBenedetto - I would like to see a change where the Chairperson cannot refuse to have an item placed on the agenda. Mr. Ruseau - Our charter says we have to follow Robert's Rules, which gives the Chair that authority. Mr. Ruggiero - If there is a pressing item any ruling of the Chair can be overridden. If it is an emergency situation. We would need a supermajority. Ms. DiBenedetto - I can accept that that is a rule, but I feel it is censorship. I object, but I can move forward with this. Motion to accept the report offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Report of the Superintendent: Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We held an administrative retreat on June 17-19. The work that was started at the retreat will continue over the summer and we will have another retreat in August. Summer School and Summer Fun Day Camp began today. The Vocational School hosted CTE camp for middle schoolers last week and over 40 students participated. Many athletic camps are also being hosted by the MHS Basketball, Volleyball and Soccer Programs. The Mustang Girls Softball Team finished the season with 19-3 record. Congratulations to Coach Dempsey, Coach Pagliarulo and the girls on a fantastic season. Captain Brenna Forbes will be named to both the Boston Globe and the Boston Herald's All Scholastic Softball Teams. Tristen Howard competed nationally in the 200 meters last weekend. We applaud him for a fantastic year and look forward to his senior year in the fall. Athletic Director Bob Maloney and Headmaster Paul D'Alleva welcomed a new Girls Basketball Coach at MHS: Molly Waitt. We welcome Coach Waitt to the Mustang Family. Last Saturday, the winners from the Andrews Middle School's 7th Grade Science Fair were asked to present their work at the MIT Museum for visitors and guests. The students Eric Brown, Matthew Harris and Sarah Braverman, attended with their teacher, Eric Prileson. Some of you were able to join with us as Medford High School's Gay Straight Alliance, (GSA), dedicated the Pride Flag along with a plaque that reads "Love Wins" in the Main Lobby of the school. If you noticed in last Thursday's Globe, the GSA was highlighted for their participation in Boston's 2019 Pride Parade. We applaud Nicole Chalifoux and Emily Simpson and all the students for their outstanding work. We have spoken a lot about the opportunity for the middle school students to work together and this year, "Learn something, make something in the library," was introduced to students in the Andrews and McGlynn Middle School libraries. The MPS Middle School Libraries and Medford Public Library successfully partnered to offer a series of STEAM Workshops to middle school students during the year. All workshops were held after school in the school library about every other week alternating between the two schools. The Medford Public Schools would like to thank the Medford Public Library, the Medford Arts Council and the Massachusetts Cultural Council for their support of this wonderful project.

Motion to suspend the rules to take paper 3 out of order offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Recognition of Kiwani Club Literacy Project - Diane Caldwell - Welcome the Medford Kiwanis. We thank them for their outstanding support of the Literacy Project, and their year long support of students and staff in Medford, making positive impressions upon our students. We would like to present you with a certificate of appreciation.

Motion to revert to regular order of business offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve MassGeneral Cannabis Study - Toni Wray - This is a voluntary survey for high school students. Mass General Hospital requires students and parents approval.

Motion to accept MassGeneral Cannabis Study offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Mr. Ruseau - Motion to amend to include middle schoolers, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto. Mr. Ruggiero - Can we add a question on vaping? Dr. Schuster - It is included already. Mr. Ruggiero - Can we add a question about obesity and sugary drink consumption, if it does not jeopardize the validity of the study? Dr. Schuster - It would not jeopardize the validity of the study. The IRB may question it, if they say it is okay that is fine. Mr. Ruggiero - It does not require an amendment.

Motion to accept the MassGeneral Cannabis Study as amended offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. Kreatz.

Roll Call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve No School Choice offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve School Committee Meeting Dates for SY 2019-2020 offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, including a note that the Budget Hearing should be listed in advance. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Report on Feasibility of Universal Free Breakfast Using Provision 2 - Kirsteen Patterson - The recommendation is to do Provision 2 breakfast as a pilot for the first quarter, September, October, November of 2019, then report out on participation and funding rates in December of 2019 to School Committee. Ms. DiBenedetto - Is this the same as Breakfast After the Bell? Ms. Patterson - There are different ways to deliver breakfast. We have had it served in all school buildings, but this would encourage more participation and provide it for free. Ms. DiBenedetto - Is this the same as the \$10,000 grant for Breakfast After the Bell? Ms. Patterson - That is different. Ms. DiBenedetto - Did you look at both programs and decide between them? Ms. Patterson - We did not have time to wait. \$10,000 may not be enough. Ms. DiBenedetto - I want to make sure we utilize all of our options. Mr. Ruseau - The two schools that have free breakfast are the McGlynn Elementary School and the Columbus Elementary School. The Columbus has about 93% participation in breakfast and the McGlynn has 22%. The difference is the Columbus breakfast is after the bell. If it is not after the bell, it will be a waste of three months. Ms. Patterson - We would roll it out to get the excitement that we would gather participation level and reach out to the parents. After the Bell is much more of a challenge to coordinate in the buildings. Mr. Ruseau - What if a bus is late? Ms. Patterson - Principals could adjust. Mr. Ruseau - If we opt out after 3 months does it mean we are out for next year? Ms. Patterson - No. Mr. Ruggiero - Thank you for expediting this report. I would rather consistent After the Bell program. Ms. Caldwell - Time in learning is mandated by the state. Every child should have a good breakfast. I think every principal has to buy in. I suggest we move forward with Ms. Patterson's suggestion.

Mr. Ruggiero - What are we capable of as a community? I would like to make a motion to do a universal After the Bell Program. Ms. Patterson - As much as that would be ideal, our food service is not prepared to do After the Bell Program. We are trying to do a full scale broad based breakfast option for all students as a pilot program, including hot food and fresh fruits and vegetables. The hope was to pilot a program that would engage the community and offer varying items for the students. Mr. Ruseau - I understand the pilot, but if there is a chance we would turn it off, I would not support that. Administrators should not decide to turn it off. Ms. Patterson - It would be a vote of the committee to continue or end the program in December.

Melanie McLaughlin - I am shocked by Columbus participation numbers of 93% who utilize breakfast compared to McGlynn with utilization at 22%.

Ms. Van der Kloot - I know principals will make it work. Ms. Mustone - Thank you Ms. Patterson and Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent. After 3 years we are finally dealing with breakfast in the schools. I appreciate this compromise.

Motion to approve the pilot program offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Mustone. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Condolences to the families of Rosemary Nicholson and Joseph Grandy.

Committee of the Whole - Superintendent's Evaluation: Motion to discuss paper that was tabled offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Mayor Burke - The Superintendent had a unanimous vote of proficient. We feel very positive about how students and staff have responded. We appreciate how you use data to help make the district better. We plan to file the evaluation with DESE tomorrow. Ms. Van der Kloot - It is wonderful to see how Dr. Edouard-Vincent has done this year. It was a strong first year and she has such potential.

Motion to approve the report and file with DESE offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Report on Budget Hearing - Mayor Burke - Three motions were made in the Budget Hearing:

-Arrange Meeting with Supt / Fallon /D'Alleva - PE/Fine Arts

-Arrange Professional Development for PE/Adaptive Training

-Develop a Checklist for those who rent school facilities - work with John McLaughlin

Motion to accept with three motions offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Motion to approve the budget offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, with the qualification that Ms. Van der Kloot is not voting on paraprofessionals and Ms. DiBenedetto is not voting on substitutes. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Motion to enter executive session offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Adjourned for executive session at 8:23 PM.